07

Five steps, five gates

The method is a rhythm, not a programme. Each step is timeboxed and closes with a gate held by a named executive. A gate can pass, adjust or stop — **never drift**.

1	**Mandate & diagnosis** Costs, heatmap, gap map, one selected workflow	**CEO** 15 working days
2	**Readiness & capability** A verdict per domain: proceed, fix in parallel, fix first	**CEO + CIO** 10 working days
3	**Direction** A North Star AI vision and a portfolio sequenced on impact and feasibility	**CEO** 10 working days
4	**Workflow activation** Four redesign moves, the dip managed, value measured by Finance	**COO** 6–12 weeks each
5	**Anchoring & scaling** Governance into the line; funding only at 1.5× verified value	**CFO** Continuous

FOR THE CEO

You carry the mandate: open the first gate, set the course, and protect the single priority list. **Coherence cannot be delegated to a transformation office** — the gates rotate across the executive team for that reason.

Diagnose first: fifteen working days

Five domains are scored against the three signals on a heatmap. Every cell needs an artefact: **a red without evidence is a grievance; an amber without evidence is a hope.** The reddest, costliest cell is where you start.

DOMAIN	WAITING DECISIONS	TRAVELLING WORK	COMPETING PRIORITIES
Business	RED	AMBER	AMBER
Data	AMBER	RED	GREEN
Technology	GREEN	RED	AMBER
Governance	RED	AMBER	RED
People	AMBER	GREEN	RED

Illustrative scoring. Your heatmap comes from your own artefacts: decision logs, workflow walks, data lineage, allocation maps.

A companion **gap map** makes three recurring gaps undeniable: the *ownership gap*, the *boundary gap* and the *capacity gap*.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ✔ Five gates, each with a named owner and the right to stop.
- ✔ No workflow enters activation without a baseline and North Star link.
- ✔ Evidence, not opinion, decides where the transformation starts.